

Conceptual Lenses for Inquiry Planning

at

NGARRI PRIMARY SCHOOL

Social Responsibility

Students will investigate local and global communities and consider the challenges and opportunities associated with living in a diverse society. This lens is about social organisation and the ways in which people are connected to and have responsibility for each other. Students will explore the concept of change, discovering ways in which the past has made us who we are and how and why society changes over time. Students will develop citizenship by building skills for active involvement in their community.



Environmental Sustainability

Students will investigate our dependence on a healthy natural environment. Investigations focus on the diversity and richness of the natural environment and the ways in which humans use and interact with the environment. Importantly, this lens emphasises the need to care for and live responsibly with the environment - at a local, national and global level.



The Physical World

Students will investigate the systems that govern physical phenomena in both the natural and built environment. They will become more aware of how science can help us explain the way the world works and the impact of science and technology on our lives. As students work through scientific problem solving, experimenting and gathering data, they become aware of the powerful role that design, technology and scientific thinking have in the world. This lens also promotes the processes used to innovate , create, make and evaluate.



Identity, Creativity and Wellbeing

Students will investigate their uniqueness, talents and passions, and inquire into how to best nurture themselves - physically, emotionally, mentally and spiritually. This lens focuses on how we can work towards our potential, develop resilience, build healthy relationships and make wise choices. It fosters self-expression, resilience and creativity and explores how we change and grow. This lens is also about expressions through the arts and how this in turn helps us communicate with others.



These four broad, conceptual lenses help provide a framework against which to review and plan for inquiry teaching and learning - they are intended to be across Victorian Curriculum learning areas and capabilities. They are to be revisited each year, so students can gain an increasingly complex understanding of the big ideas through exploring them in a range of contexts over time. This will help them to make connections and build understanding beyond facts.